

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter 
in association with

WITH THANKS

We, Ian Murdo and Angus, would like to express our heartfelt thanks to the people of Bernera and Tir Mor for the condolences expressed by phone calls, cards and gifts on the passing of our dear mother Chrissie Macdonald "Lochside", 13 Breacleit.

It was so moving to see so many friends and neighbours standing by the roadside as we took her home to Bosta for the last time. This expression of love and respect made a deep impression on us. We cannot thank you enough for the help and care given to Chrissie over the years in her home in Breacleit.

Many thanks to Rev Hugh Stewart for conducting the service at the cemetery, and to the Bernera Firemen, who gave such invaluable assistance in Bosta. God bless you all.



Welcome to the 4th issue of the Bernera News.

We want to say a big thank you to all those who have supported us, from delivering copies to sending us pieces to include. We really are so grateful to you all.

If you have something you'd like to share, or a story to tell please don't hesitate to get in touch with us. We'd particularly like to hear from some of the younger members of the community for our Postcards from the Islands. Just write us a few words about what you've been up to, or something you're interested in, and preferably include a photo, and send it to us so we can share your story.

In the meantime we hope you enjoy this issue, and thank you once again for all the contributions received.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

BUS UPDATE

As of 6pm on Friday 26th June no definite decisions have been published with regard to the bus service. It is believed that there may be a small increase in the service on offer from next week, including that of limited none-keyworker travel, but details have yet to be finalised. We will of course share any information as we receive it on both our website and facebook page. However, for those of you without access to the internet wanting an update please get in touch and we will call you back with any information as soon as we know it.

CORONAVIRUS UPDATE

Now we're in phase 2 there are a few changes to consider. You can now meet up with two other households at a time, as long as you remain outdoors, maintain social distancing of 2 metres at all times, and that there are a maximum of 8 people.

If you live alone, or only with others under 18, you can now agree to form an 'extended household' with one other household. Everyone in the extended household will be able to spend time together inside as well as out, and do not need to maintain the 2 metre distancing with each other. Overnight stays are also permitted.

It is advised that people who are shielding only meet with one other household at a time, and do not form

extended households just yet.

Physical distancing, hand washing and respiratory hygiene remain the most important and effective measures to prevent the spread of coronavirus. However, it is also now strongly recommended that a face covering is worn in enclosed environments, such as shops. They are also compulsory on public transport, such as buses, and public transport premises, such as airports. Children under 5 should not wear a face covering, and those with certain health conditions may also be exempt.

Information taken from the Scottish Government website

FACE COVERINGS

A face covering is a facial covering of the mouth and nose, that is made of cloth or other textiles and through which you can breathe, for example a scarf.

When applying or removing the

covering, it is important that you wash your hands first and avoid touching your face. After each use, you must wash a fabric face covering at 60 degrees centigrade or dispose of it safely.

Follow the simple instructions below to make your own mask, otherwise we do have a small number of simple sewn cloth face coverings available for those in the community. Please contact us if you would like one.

A simple mask using a piece of cloth and elastic bands

- Start with a piece of material approximately 50cm by 50cm.
- Lay the cloth out flat, then fold in half.
- Fold the top third down, and the bottom third up to meet it.
- Thread the now folded material through two elastic bands (hair ties would also work) so that the bands are 12cm apart
- Fold each side to the middle and tuck as tightly as possible into the folds.
- The mask can now be worn.



ON THE SOFA... BERNERA CAFE

For this issue we caught up with Gez Shearman-Earp, from Bernera Cafe. His business has recently been engaged by Bernera Community Association to provide a Friday night takeaway service from the café kitchen.

Tell us a little about the menu choices.

It starts each week with menu planning and the development of dishes. I always try and include at least 1 vegan and 1 gluten free option, as well as creating a choice of different meat dishes. I'm very aware that not everyone likes spicier food, so try to provide a balance as well as something different for people to enjoy.

How does the take-away service work?

We publish the menu on a Wednesday morning, both on Facebook, as well as in the window of the cafe kitchen. Anyone can also phone up and enquire what is on the menu each week. Orders can be made by phoning us directly on **07762 128 108**, or by text or Whatsapp to the same number before 5pm on the Thursday.

How does payment work?

Where possible we like to send people a link which takes them through to an online payment system. It's a secure site, so perfectly safe for people to use. Otherwise we can take payment over the phone, or if needed we offer a contactless payment on collection service.

What happens with collection?

When you order your food you're given a collection time. We use a window in the kitchen as a serving hatch to reduce contact due to the current coronavirus situation. Each meal is prepared to your time, and is individually packaged. We've worked very hard to minimise the environmental impact of our takeaway packaging. The foil trays we use are of aluminium and so once washed can be put into general recycling. All other packaging, including lids, trays etc, are made from a fully compostable material. This means that you can put all of it straight into your food waste bin after eating.

How does the pricing work?

At the moment all main meals are being subsidised by the Bernera Community Association. They contribute half of the cost, with the customer paying the other half. The price of the meals is kept as good value as possible, but obviously I have to cover my costs, as well as paying for the staff who I have working with me.

What are the future plans with the cafe?

Unfortunately it's too early to say at the moment. We had planned to open 6 days a week during the busy tourist season, but because of the impact of coronavirus, that is all still in the air. If there is enough demand as we settle into the 'new normal', then I hope to be able to go back to at least some daytime opening.



BERNERA HISTORICAL SOCIETY AND MUSEUM

Over the past twenty years the volunteers of the Comunn Eachdraidh have gathered together a great deal of information on the history and people of Bernera and Tir Mor, which is now kept in a digital archive in the museum. At the same time, one of the main requests made is for a history of Bernera and Tir Mor covering most, if not all, aspects of the island's past.

The Trustees have been considering putting together something for a while

and have now decided that with the continuing restrictions this is a good time to start this project. Available data is being collated from within the archive but there are many gaps or little information and so we are asking the people of Bernera and Tir Mor to help if possible. Anyone who has information, photos, records or stories that could be useful for this project are asked if they would be so kind to provide to the museum (all items will be scanned and returned as required

or donated). If you can email to **berneramuseum1@gmail.com**, pass to one of the committee or put through the letter box at the community centre addressed to the museum that would be great. The committee members are: **Callum Macaulay, Ian Mackay, Colin Halliday, Kathanna Latimer, Elizabeth Macleod and Ken Macaulay.**

The following topics have been identified as ones of interest but any other information is most welcome.

Geology : **Neolithic**; Iron Age : Duns : Vikings : Bosta village early to abandoned : Clans : Clearances : Emigration : 17th to 19th **Century** : Kirkibost first and second settlement : Little Bernera : Schools in Bernera : Gaelic schools in Tobson and Kirkibost : Churches in Bernera : Lobster Ponds : Bernera Riot : Little Bernera and Bosta **cemetery's** : WWI and WWII : Disease (eg Spanish Flu) and Health services : Crofts and Shielings : Free Gift Crofts : The Bridge : Pre/post Electricity : Bernera Halls : Shops on Bernera : Bernera estate and owners : Fishing and Herring Girls : House type changes : Population changes : Working life : Postal service : First Vehicles on Bernera : Oral Traditions and stories.



Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

NEIL MACLEOD AND THE PRIAM GOLD

While holding up on Berisay between 1610 and 1613 Neil Macleod got a reputation for being a pirate. One day he spotted a ship named Priam captained by Peter Love, another pirate based in the Isle of Man, heading for Kirkibost. It is not known why the Priam was making for Kirkibost but it became reasonable to Neil Macleod to assume that there was an opportunity for him to benefit from whatever misfortune caused the Priam to seek safety.

It is not clear if he befriended Captain Love or he decided to plunder the cargo but he gained control of the vessel by fair or foul means with many of the crew trying to escape onto Great Bernera. Those that survived were rounded up and handed over to the constabulary. They were then taken to Edinburgh and brought to trial for murder and piracy on the high seas. They were found guilty and hanged in Leith. Neil Macleod had hoped that by

handing the ship over to the authorities he may gain a pardon for whatever unlawful exploits he and his followers had been up to during the preceding years. This was not to be the case. On board the Priam was a considerable amount of gold and silver amassed during their exploits in the Atlantic. Some of this hoard was plundered in turn by Neil Macleod and his cohorts. Some of the local lads were arrested for looting and impressed into the army - a standard punishment at the time for miscreants.

Legend has it that as two of these young men detained buried their shares close to each other at a place 'A Ghrianan bhig on Great Bernera. It is thought that in the early 1800's one of the pots of gold was found but the finder, not knowing what was in the pot, asked a passing Irish tinker if he had seen anything like that before and if it had any value.

The peddler, rubbing his hands in glee said he had no idea what the contents were, but that he would do him a favour and take the pot and the value of its contents back to him on his return visit, and as a gesture of goodwill would leave him a pair of boots to be paid for on his return. Needless to say the peddler was never seen again.

The other pot of gold has, so far as we know, never been found.



A' MHIOS BUIDHE - THE YELLOW MONTH

Painting for me is about colour and textures, memories and surroundings. I paint the sea a lot, for many reasons: I live beside it, I watch it, I worked on it, I swim in it. It is a part of who I am.

The moor is too; I love the way it changes over the year, the colours that can seem so subtle until you get up close, then you can see acid greens, crimson, golden yellow, purple, that combine and change from spring green to the autumn orange that glows in the dusk at the end of the day. But at this time of year, for me, it is the machair that holds me. July and the flowers through the grass that in each place, or every machair, so very different in place and by the year, dependent on the weather, the amount of rain and sun.



A' Mhios Buidhe "the yellow month" is said to be July, although in truth there

is yellow in different forms from spring right through summer and into autumn. Different machairs have different species, lots of daisies at Bosta, some Harris machairs have more pink and blues. But in particular on different visits to Ness what struck me in particular was the machair at Ness play park which is full of vetches, buttercups and cellandines, and the epitome of this, A' Mhios Buidhe and I have been compelled to paint this many times. It is the very definition of what summer should be, light and bright and playful.

At this time of year I would have been in the throes of getting ready for our stall at HebCelt, where I've had a stall myself or as a collective with Annie Maynard Ceramics and Diggory Brown. To put oneself in the public eye is not easy, but the reward is to talk to people who come from virtually all over the world because they are fascinated by our island, the culture, the land and seascape, the language and the people.

This year, of course, is a bit different, and instead of getting ready to show my work and share our island, I will have HebCelt week to walk along the moor to look at the hills across the loch, to swim in the sea, to lie on the



machair breathing in the scent of the flowers and the sea to look at the night sky and to paint; to put down all that surrounds me every day, and that makes me who I am; and to enjoy it, somewhat selfishly perhaps, for a little while longer, just for me. For us.

Ros Paterson is an artist from Bernera. Her work is influenced by the local landscape, in particular the bands of colour she sees around her on the island. Ros's collection of artwork ranges from mini wearable art, to travel sized paintings and larger work. Take a look at her facebook page www.facebook.com/rospaintythings/

Ros Paterson
Kirkibost



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS...

Mark Styles is a musician living in Tobson, he sent us these few words about his upcoming new album.

Hi all.

I am very pleased to announce the release of my latest mix genre music album **"Livin' the dream"**.

This album is the product of three hard months of playing, recording and mastering during the lock down period. All instruments, with the exception of the drum kit, are played by myself. The songs and music are written and composed by me and the vocals, recording and final mastering are by me also.

The album content is a mixture of

Country, Rock, Punk, Rockabilly and Indie and is available right now on my website store "markstylesmusic.com". Most online digital stores will host my album from 1st July 2020 and actual CDs and vinyl will be available from Amazon on demand then.

I have been very fortunate to get radio play on worldwide rockabilly radio and a number of uk and us country channels. Please check out my website and feel free to message and leave comments. Hope you enjoy!



Mark Styles
Tobson



BERNERA BAKES... SODA BREAD

This is the recipe for soda bread which is yummy with a bowl of home-made soup.

250g Plain Flour
250g Wholemeal Flour
1 teaspoon salt
400mls butter milk



- Sift all dry ingredients together.
- Add butter milk.
- Knead to form a loaf shape. Score into 4.
- Bake at 200°C for ½ hour.

Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

This fantastic quiz has been sent in from Colin. Answers will appear in the next issue.

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| 1. Russian Imperial family massacred 1918 | 13. Howard Hughes' famous plane | 24. 8 out of 10 owners said their cats prefer... |
| 2. Para Handy's Puffer | 14. Radio Times greatest Sports Personality winner | 25. Forced from Acre in 129 |
| 3. Amazon cetaceans | 15. Scotland's longest river | 26. Car that only came in black |
| 4. Defender of Bernera Rioters | 16. Home of Cadbury | 27. Principality in the Pyrenees |
| 5. Cube of 10 | 17. Electronics firm set up by Lord Sugar | 28. Captain Kidd's base in Indian Ocean |
| 6. First savings bank est. here 1810 | 18. Marvell heroes united film franchise | 29. Built to hold back the Mongol hoards |
| 7. Day named for Norse God Thor | 19. Scotland's oldest university | 30. Who worshipped cats |
| 8. Raised from Solent in 1982 | 20. Eastern most town in Britain | |
| 9. The Scottish play | 21. Worlds tallest tree species | |
| 10. Hero of Mafeking | 22. Lady Jane Grey was queen for how many days | |
| 11. Reduced to dwarf planet in 2006 | 23. "That will do nicely..." | |
| 12. Presenter of Question Time | | |

ALPHABET QUIZ - ANSWERS

Answers from Issue #3:

N.	November	S.	Suffragettes	X.	Xerox
O.	Oceanic	T.	Tommy	Y.	Yuri Gagarin
P.	Pyramid	U.	Ultravox	Z.	Zulu
Q.	Quad Bike	V.	Vera		
R.	Red	W.	Westminster		

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS...

It's been great to get out more recently. I went to the beach and found a pallet I called Timmy and tried to turn it into a surfboard, mostly it just sunk but it was fun. I have been out in the kayak on the three lochs and saw some big fish. I really need a haircut though I hope the barbers opens soon and we can play in the park with others because I miss that.

Sebastian, 10, Kirkibost



'OISEAN A' CHALMAN', BANCA PAISDE (DOVE'S WING, BABY BANK)

Oisean a' Chalman, Banca Paisde (Dove's Wing, Baby Bank) continues to provide help for families by supplying key items for babies and toddlers between 0-36 months. It also provides targeted help for older children and young adults. Established by a charitable start-up grant from the Church of Scotland 'Go For It' Fund, generous donations received locally and nationally, and liaison with the Salvation Army, Oisean a' Chalman has been pleased to supply clothes, nursery equipment, nappies, wipes and toiletries to a growing number of families over the past few months.

Clothing has been screened into different age and gender appropriate groupings to aid viewing and choice. Viewing can be accessed personally, or by electronic means.

You may access the service by telephoning the **CONFIDENTIAL** contact number: **07903 311934**. All requests made to Oisean A' Chalman are treated in absolute confidence and it is open for use by all families in the area.

The strictest Health & Safety protocols are applied to all aspects of the service.

'FOR WHOM THE BELL TOLLS'

Chaucer wrote that 'Time and Tide waits for no man or woman'.

As we observe the Tidal Bell in Bosta we see proof of this simple proverb. Between high tide and low tide the sea ebbs away from the coastline. Likewise, when the tide rises, the waves once again reach the shoreline.

The arrival of high tide heralded by the clear distinct sound of a ringing bell some distance from shore. A pleasant, evocative, and inspiring sound.

The waves that inspire the sound having travelled far and wide since they initially set off from the other side of the Atlantic Ocean many days before. Little did they expect to end up in Bosta, Great Bernera.

An observation that many may concur with, not with disappointment but with awesome thankfulness. For some it has involved a lifetime of travel, with others, as has always been, from birth.

Destinations are important none more so than spiritually. And destination was at the very centres of His ministry providing all who trust in Him with a glorious promise:

'In My Father's house are many [a]mansions; if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and receive you to Myself; that where I am, there you may be also', **John 14:2-4**



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Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



VIRTUAL SERVICES.

For those of you with access to the internet, Lochs-in-Bernera Church of Scotland offers regular virtual services as listed below.

Online Sunday Service - 10:30 am

(Available on the Church's FB page or Youtube Channel)

Online Sunday School - 12 noon

Online Prayer Meeting - 7 pm each Thursday evening.

Both the online Sunday School and the Prayer Meeting are hosted on video conferencing. They are open to all, please

email the Minister at **berneralwuig@btinternet.com** to receive a secure invitation.

PASTORAL CARE

The Minister is available 24/7 to offer pastoral care to anyone in the Parish of Bernera whether or not they come to church.

He may be contacted on: **(01851) 672 388** or **07971 057915** or by e-mail at **berneralwuig@btinternet.com**.